

EN ▾



FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC

HOME > FRANCE

French AI startup AMI raises \$1B to develop 'universal intelligent systems'

FRANCE

French artificial intelligence startup AMI on Tuesday said it has raised \$1 billion to develop AI systems designed to understand the physical world "in the way animals and humans do", unlike the language-based models behind chatbots such as ChatGPT. The company said it expected to produce "fairly universal intelligent systems" within five years.


Home


Shows


Live


Newsfeed


Menu



Co-founder of French artificial intelligence startup AMI Yann LeCun attends the World Economic Forum annual meeting in Davos on January 23, 2025. © Fabrice Coffrini, AFP

French artificial intelligence startup AMI, co-founded by [Meta's](#) former chief AI scientist Yann LeCun, announced Tuesday it has raised \$1 billion to develop models able to understand the physical world.

This first funding round for AMI (Advanced Machine Intelligence) was carried out by five investment funds and attracted investment from several big groups, including [Toyota](#), [Nvidia](#) and [Samsung](#).

Notable names in tech, including former [Google](#) CEO Eric Schmidt and Amazon founder [Jeff Bezos](#), also bought in.

LeCun told AFP that, with the funding round complete, AMI would bring aboard 20-30 people "in the very short term".

EN ▾





FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC


Home


Shows


Live


Newsfeed


Menu

EN ▾



FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC

"I am very clearly in the camp that believes we need a paradigm shift" from the AI reliance on LLMs, he told AFP.

LeCun has been a vocal critic of major AI developers' laser focus on LLMs, which was one reason for why he left Meta – although he insists he still has "a good relationship with [Mark Zuckerberg](#)".

AMI's work will take up where LeCun left off with research at Meta on a new AI architecture dubbed JEPA.

"It's a direct continuation of that project," he said.

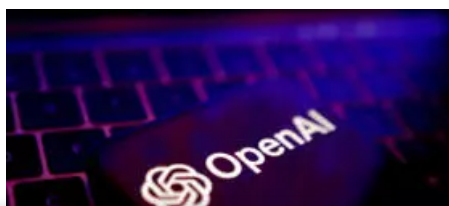
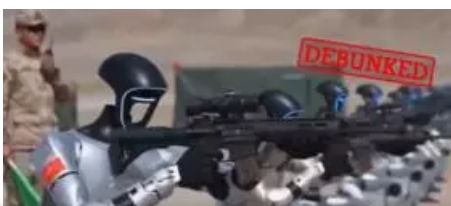
Researchers hope world models will allow AI systems to analyse and predict the behaviour of complex systems, such as a jet engine, a power plant or the organs of a human patient.

LeCun, a dual French-American citizen who remains a computer science professor at New York University, said AMI would focus on research and development in its first year.

Discussions with corporate partners could be held within six to 12 months, he added.

(FRANCE 24 with AFP)

READ NEXT



Home



Shows



Live



Newsfeed



Menu

EN 





FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC


Home


Shows


Live


Newsfeed


Menu

EN ▾





FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC


Home


Shows


Live


Newsfeed


Menu

EN ▾





FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC


Home


Shows


Live


Newsfeed


Menu

EN ▾



FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC

INTERNATIONAL

USA

United Kingdom

Canada

Australia

Germany

India

Netherlands

South Africa

Italy

ABOUT FRANCE 24

Who are we?

Ethics and transparency

Press room

Contact France 24

Report a problem with our content

Report a technical issue

Advertising

Content licensing

Join us

FRANCE MÉDIAS MONDE WEBSITES

RFI

Learn French

RFI Instrumental

MCD

InfoMigrants

ENTR

ZOA

CFI

Académie

France Médias Monde

SERVICES

Newsletters

RSS feeds

Watch France 24 on TV



Home



Shows



Live



Newsfeed



Menu

EN ▾



FRANCE

AFRICA

MIDDLE EAST

AMERICAS

EUROPE

ASIA-PACIFIC



Legal notice

Accessibility: partially compliant

Privacy

Cookies

Manage my privacy settings

Notifications

Facebook

Bluesky

Threads

Instagram

YouTube

TikTok

WhatsApp

Telegram

SoundCloud

© 2026 Copyright France 24 - All rights reserved. France 24 is not responsible for the content of external websites. Audience ratings certified by ACPM.



Home



Shows



Live



Newsfeed



Menu